
Section 8.4 Religion: crime and punishment

This section MUST be based on a study of Christianity and ONE other religion.

Students will be required to: demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specification; express their own responses to the issues and questions raised by the specification using reasons and evidence; evaluate alternative points of view about these issues and questions.

Key words — addiction, capital punishment, crime, deterrence, judgment, justice, law, reform, rehabilitation, responsibility, retribution, sin

- The need for law and justice.
- Theories of punishment and the arguments for and against them.
- Why justice is important for Christians.
- Why justice is important for the followers of one religion other than Christianity.
- The nature of capital punishment and non-religious arguments about capital punishment.
- Different attitudes to capital punishment among Christians and the reasons for them.
- Different attitudes to capital punishment in one religion other than Christianity.
- Laws on drugs and alcohol and the reasons for them.
- Social and health problems caused by drugs and alcohol.
- Different attitudes to drugs and alcohol in Christianity and the reasons for them.
- Attitudes to drugs and alcohol in one religion other than Christianity.

Unit 9 Christianity

Content overview

This unit requires students to study the nature of Christianity and its effects on the life of Christian believers in the UK. There are four sections covering beliefs and values, community and tradition, worship and celebration, and living the Christian life.

Key words are given at the beginning of each section. Students should be aware of their meanings and be able to use them in their examination answers. A glossary of the key words can be found in *Appendix 4*.

In order to meet Assessment Objective 2, students need to be aware of a range of responses addressing religious and/or non-religious beliefs.

Assessment overview

Assessment will be through a one-and-a-half-hour examination. The examination will be divided into four sections and students will be expected to choose one of the two questions set on each section, ie four questions in total. Each question is sub-divided into four parts structured on an incline of difficulty.

Religious Studies papers are designed to give access to the full range of grades and are not tiered.

Quality of Written Communication will be assessed through Assessment Objective 1 in part c) of each question.